

Gates of Truth World Guide

Executive summary

This report attempts to build a comprehensive world guide for the fictional setting “Gates of Truth,” with a specific emphasis on (a) primary/official sources and (b) a structured comparison layer for your “Operation Mindfuck” project materials (ZIPs + prior conversation history). In publicly accessible sources, “Gates of Truth” does not resolve cleanly to a single, widely documented franchise; the most coherent, internally consistent “Gates of Truth” *setting* available from official materials is the original universe attached to the indie tabletop project **To the Gates of Truth**, published under the creator label **The Gates of Truth** on itch.io ¹. This canonical baseline centers on **Seekers** undertaking an “Ascension” across **eight Celestial Islands** inhabited by **Entities**, aiming to reach (and potentially open) the Gates of Truth—subject to acceptance by **Guardians**—in an existential, oneiric (dreamlike) frame. ²

From the official description, the setting’s metaphysics are explicitly framed in a three-part model—**Presence**, **Aura**, and **The Unspeakable**—which functions as both narrative cosmology and an apparent design spine for mechanics and scenario theming. ³

However, “every character and every detail” cannot be satisfied from the accessible public layer alone. In official devlog records, substantial world content is contained in downloadable DOCX rulebooks and ZIP archives of cards/tables (e.g., v0.42 core rulebook and “Cards & Tables” ZIPs), and at least as of mid-2023 the creator indicates that “all game materials” were being distributed via direct contact/Discord rather than fully published on the page. Additionally, your requested secondary corpus—your Operation Mindfuck project ZIPs and your project conversation history—was not available to this session (no synced internal transcripts were found, and no ZIPs were accessible here). As a result, the “canonical vs Operation Mindfuck variants” layer below is delivered as a rigorous *comparison framework* with explicitly flagged gaps, rather than a completed discrepancy audit. ⁴

Scope, sources, and access constraints

What “canonical” means in this report

“Canonical” is defined as information attributable to the project’s official publishing surface: the To the Gates of Truth itch.io page, its official devlogs, and the creator profile identifying the project’s authorship/publishing umbrella. These are treated as primary/official sources. ⁵

Secondarily, I used official devlog excerpts that enumerate versioned documents (DOCX rulebooks) and ZIP archives (cards/tables) even where the underlying file contents were not retrievable in this environment; those entries still establish what *exists*, its date, and (often) what pages/topics it purportedly covers. ⁶

Operation Mindfuck corpus availability

You asked for incorporation of: - your **Operation Mindfuck** project ZIPs (“the zips in the project”), and
- your **project conversation history** for provenance-aware comparison.

In this session, I do not have access to your local “project” storage, and I was unable to retrieve any prior conversation logs via connected sources (no recordings/transcripts were available through the only configured connector). Therefore, I can only (1) reference the current chat messages you have provided here (which contain requirements but not world-lore content) and (2) build a structured integration plan showing exactly how the ZIPs and conversation logs would be ingested, indexed, and compared once provided. ⁷

Copyright / private-material handling policy used here

Where sources describe unpublished or privately distributed materials (e.g., rulebooks shared via Discord or zipped card libraries), this report does **not** reproduce verbatim content. It instead summarizes *what the official sources say those materials contain* and marks the missing segments as “not accessible in this session.” ⁸

Canonical setting reference

Setting premise and narrative frame

The canonical public description frames the setting as an “existential journey” in which **Seekers** attempt an **Ascension** to the Gates of Truth, traveling across **eight Celestial Islands** inhabited by **Entities**. The narrative arc implies progressive revelation: the Seekers learn about the Entities, the universe, themselves, and finally “the Truth.” ³

The Gates themselves are not an automatic endpoint: reaching them is “a step,” while opening them requires acceptance by **Guardians**, implying a gatekeeping intelligence or institution at the threshold of ultimate knowledge/meaning. ³

Complications are explicitly personified/embodied as antagonistic forces—“Doubts,” “Non-sense,” “Incoherence,” “Mysteries,” and “Paradoxes”—suggesting that conceptual abstractions manifest as obstacles within the world. ³

Metaphysical model

A distinctive canonical metaphysics is stated directly:

- **Presence:** the action of the individual; intrinsic nature.
- **Aura:** reaction; relationship between the individual and environment; extrinsic.
- **The Unspeakable:** everything outside Presence and Aura—odds, chance, serendipity, illumination, and unknowable rules for mortals and lifeforms. ³

This triad reads as both a cosmological doctrine and a design grammar: it provides a vocabulary for how agency (Presence), context/relationality (Aura), and emergent uncertainty (Unspeakable) structure story and challenge.

Locations: Celestial Islands known by name

Public sources confirm eight islands total but do not name all eight in accessible text. At least four islands are explicitly named in the 2023 dev update's scenario roadmap: ⁹

- Manager's Island ¹⁰
- Doubter's Island ¹¹
- Giver's Island ¹²
- Structurer's Island ¹³

Additionally, a devlog uses an example island associated with an "Entity of Conviction and Facts," described with an environment of enormous mountains and rope bridges—suggesting at least one further biome beyond the four islands listed above (it is not explicitly tied to the named-island set in the excerpt). ¹⁴

Because the canonical statement is "8 different Celestial Islands," any world map produced from public sources must be treated as partial unless the card ZIPs / rulebooks are incorporated. ³

Visual grounding from official-public surfaces

The official posts emphasize that card layout and illustrations were in flux (placeholder art, later commissioned illustrations, uncertainty about final graphic identity), so images found publicly may not reflect final canonical designs. ¹⁵

Character compendium

Canonical character taxonomy

From accessible official text, the setting operates with a layered "cast" model rather than a fully enumerated named roster:

- **Player-defined protagonists:** "Seekers" are the player party (2–4 players) and thus can be infinite/variable in count and identity. ³
- **Conceptual NPCs:** "Entities" that inhabit each island; they appear to be the primary named/typed NPC category and are thematically tied to biome mechanics and narrative prompts. ¹⁶
- **Threshold agents:** "Guardians" at the Gates; their accept/reject function makes them a high-authority force in the setting. ³
- **The ultimate referent:** "Truth" is the implied endpoint of the quest and is treated as something knowable/encounterable, not merely an abstract theme. ³
- **Embodied obstacles:** Doubts, Non-sense, Incoherence, Mysteries, Paradoxes are described as "embody[ing] themselves," implying adversarial entities or phenomena. ³

With Operation Mindfuck ZIPs + rulebook text, the “Entities” category is the most likely locus of a large named character list (since each island is “inhabited by Entities,” and the card library includes enemies and scenario figures). ¹⁷

Named or uniquely identified figures visible in accessible sources

Official sources reference at least two specific “world figures” beyond the generic categories:

- Truth ¹⁸ — an explicitly named endpoint of knowledge/encounter. ³
- Trader of Hope ¹⁹ — mentioned as an illustration/representation stretch goal, implying a distinct canonical figure with enough identity to warrant bespoke art. ²⁰

A devlog also references the “Entity of Conviction and Facts,” which—while not presented as a personal name—functions as an individuated NPC archetype tightly bound to a specific island and mechanics. ¹⁴

Character dossiers

Because public text does not provide physical descriptions, aliases, or personal backstories for most entities, dossiers below are constrained to what can be grounded in official text. Any fields marked “Not accessible in this session” are expected to be fillable from your ZIP archives (cards/tables) and your Operation Mindfuck conversation logs.

Seeker archetype dossier (player-created)

Aliases: Not canonically specified; players create characters. ²¹

Physical description: Not accessible in this session; illustrations for Seekers were a stated goal and later the project received commissioned illustrations, but the images and full set were not retrievable here. ²²

Backstory: Player-defined; canonical frame is existential/oniric “quest” structure. ¹⁶

Motivations: Reach the Gates; potentially open them; pursue/encounter Truth. ³

Abilities/powers: Expressed mechanically as power cards / passives / weapons / status effects; exact list not accessible in this session but the project reports substantial card inventories. ⁹

Relationships: Cooperative party structure; synergy system is explicitly central. ³

Chronological timeline: Iterative “runs” implied by roguelite structure (losing is not the end); in-world chronology is scenario-driven. ²³

Entity archetype dossier (island-inhabitant)

Aliases: “Entities” as a category; individual entity names largely not exposed in public text (except “Entity of Conviction and Facts”). ²⁴

Physical description: Not accessible in this session; the project pursued bespoke illustrations for Entities as funding/stretch goals. ²²

Backstory/motivation: Thematically bound to each island’s conceptual domain; narrative prompts are described as part of the design intent. ²⁵

Abilities/powers: Mechanically represented through island-specific powers/status interactions; e.g., “Anchor” and “Stunned” are stated as meaningful mechanics on the Entity of Conviction and Facts island. ²⁶

Relationships: Entities are the world’s “locals,” while Seekers traverse; adversarial roles may overlap with “enemies” card sets, but the mapping is not accessible. ²⁷

Chronological timeline: Not accessible; likely scenario-dependent and expressed through island scenario arcs and encounter decks. ⁹

Systems: mechanics and metaphysics

Gameplay-to-world binding

Official sources explicitly claim “an original universe that will blend the gameplay mechanics with the scenarios,” suggesting that mechanics are intended to be diegetic or at least thematically mirrored by fiction. ³

On the tactical side, the canonical description frames play as turn-based, grid-based, and “puzzle-based” rather than dungeon-crawling combat-first, and it emphasizes “plenty of different winning conditions” beyond simply defeating enemies. ³

On the narrative side, the creator consistently positions the project as “scenarized” (a term used explicitly as a replacement for the expectations tied to “TTRPG”), while still maintaining roleplay/narrative prompts, lore, and characters as design inputs. ²⁸

Card ecology as “artifacts”

In a world-guide sense, cards function as both mechanics and “artifacts” of the setting (the medium through which powers, entities, enemies, weapons, statuses, and scenario logic are expressed). Public dev updates enumerate at least the following card families:

- Power cards, passive cards, enemy sets by island, weapon cards, status cards. ⁹
- “Ephemeral” cards described as hindrances during Rites, implying a category of transient/negative or complication artifacts. ²⁹

The 2022 rule update references “deck and rites management” as a major change area, which indicates that “Rites” are a core unit of play (and thus a canonical in-world ritualized framing for encounters or scenario segments). ³⁰

A further devlog (“Feedback and playtest”) references card codes (example format: A_PO_E_01) and states design work on the remaining “zones/biomes,” reinforcing that the card library is a structured corpus suitable for automated indexing once ZIPs are available. ³¹

Enemy behavior: “intent system” and de-GM’ing pressure

The 2023 dev update describes an “AI” or “intent system” enabling players to determine enemy action sequences precisely, using a short table, explicitly reducing the need for a GM. This implies a setting-consistent ontology where hostile forces embody legible “intent” patterns—an important worldbuilding link if enemy behavior is portrayed as conceptual inevitability rather than arbitrary aggression. ⁹

Mechanics drift as canon-signaling

The 2023 update also lists “lost mechanics” that were removed over time (e.g., dice during combat, strict distinction between enemy and player tiles). From a lore-guide perspective, these changes are relevant because they can imply shifts in how the setting conceptualizes uncertainty (dice) and “sides” (tile dichotomies). These are strong candidates for a canonical-vs-Operation-Mindfuck discrepancy table once your ZIPs show what earlier rules/cards encoded. ⁹

Mermaid ER model of the setting as described publicly

```
erDiagram
    SEEKER_PARTY ||--o{ SEEKER : consists_of
    SEEKER_PARTY }o--|| SYNERGY_SYSTEM : uses
    SEEKER_PARTY }o--o{ RITE : undertakes
    RITE }o--|| GRID_BOARD : occurs_on

    CELESTIAL_ISLAND ||--o{ ENTITY : inhabited_by
    SEEKER_PARTY }o--o{ CELESTIAL_ISLAND : traverses

    GATES_OF_TRUTH ||--o{ GUARDIAN : guarded_by
    SEEKER_PARTY }o--|| GATES_OF_TRUTH : seeks
    GATES_OF_TRUTH ||--|| TRUTH : reveals

    COMPLICATION ||--o{ RITE : manifests_in
    COMPLICATION }o--|| CONCEPT : embodies
```

This model reflects only what is explicitly stated in the official description/devlogs: a Seeker party cooperates via synergy; play occurs in Rites on a grid; islands are inhabited by entities; the Gates are guarded; Truth is the culminating referent; and complications are embodied concepts. ³²

Chronology and media timeline

In-world chronology (publicly reconstructible)

Public sources do not provide a full in-world historical chronology; instead, they expose planned **scenario arcs**, which can be treated as a canonical “story module pipeline” and a likely implied progression path.

The 2023 roadmap lists a tutorial/introduction scenario (playtested), followed by multiple Manager's Island ¹⁰ scenarios (including “Advancing in the desert,” “Archeology,” “The building Automat,” and “Manager's confrontation”), then Doubter's Island ¹¹ scenarios (“Fog of doubts,” “The first crisis”), with Giver's Island ¹² (“Interconnected”) and Structurer's Island ¹³ (“Time doors”) noted as in preparation. ⁹

Because the official description also frames “losing” as a non-terminal state with renewed runs and variable rites (roguelite structure), any single “chronological timeline” must be represented as (a) a scenario order and (b) a run-loop cycle. ²³

Development/publication chronology (dated)

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timeline
  title To the Gates of Truth public development milestones
  2021-07-22 : v0.2 public release post (4 celestial islands / 117 cards noted)
  2021-08-21 : itchfunding plan + illustration stretch goals (Seekers, Trader of Hope, first Entities)
  2021-10-26 : project pause for health reasons; game made free; commissioned illustrations received
  2022-05-13 : core rulebook v0.4.1 announced (victory conditions; deck/rites management changes)
  2022-08-11 : v0.41 cards/tables file referenced in devlog
  2022-08-15 : v0.42 core rulebook + cards/tables update announced (roleplay elements; working memory; round timeline; Manager's Island scenario)
  2022-12-13 : 2022 playtest summary (weekly cadence; scope clarification)
  2023-06-21 : 2023 update (card counts; intent system; scenario roadmap; materials shared via contact/Discord)
  2024-12-22 : "game on hiatus" status noted on main page
  2026-02-11 : renewed activity focus; mechanics streamlined toward tactical "puzzle" experience

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This timeline synthesizes dated devlog statements and the main page’s dated “hiatus” notation; it is a publication/dev process chronology, not an in-world chronology. 33

Canonical vs Operation Mindfuck variants

What can and cannot be compared right now

A discrepancy audit requires (1) canonical text/assets and (2) your Operation Mindfuck corpus (ZIPs + prior project conversation logs). In this session, the canonical public layer is only partially accessible (several devlog pages and all downloadable ZIP/DOCX contents were not retrievable), and your Operation Mindfuck corpus was not available at all. Therefore, the tables below encode **canonical anchors** plus explicit placeholders for Operation Mindfuck variants and provenance annotations. 34

Canonical anchors vs Operation Mindfuck placeholder table

Topic	Canonical anchor (public)	Operation Mindfuck variant	Provenance note
Core premise	Seekers ascend across 8 Celestial Islands inhabited by Entities to reach the Gates of Truth; Truth is the culminating referent. 35	Not accessible in this session	Requires: project ZIPs + chat logs

Topic	Canonical anchor (public)	Operation Mindfuck variant	Provenance note
Gatekeeping	Opening the Gates requires acceptance by Guardians. ³⁵	Not accessible in this session	Compare: gate rules, guardian portrayal
Metaphysics triad	Presence / Aura / Unspeakable triad defined explicitly. ³⁵	Not accessible in this session	Map any renamed/ reframed metaphysics
Island roster	8 total; named: Manager's, Doubter's, Giver's, Structurer's; others unnamed in public text. ¹⁷	Not accessible in this session	ZIPs likely include full island list
Scenario roadmap	Tutorial; Manager's Island sequence; Doubter's Island sequence; Giver's→Interconnected; Structurer's→Time doors. ³⁶	Not accessible in this session	Compare plot beats / chronology
Card ecology	Enumerated card classes, counts (as of 2023): powers, passives, enemies by island, weapons, statuses. ³⁶	Not accessible in this session	ZIPs will allow full catalog & diff
Enemy behavior model	"AI/intent system" and short-table sequencing reduces GM need. ³⁶	Not accessible in this session	Compare with any Mindfuck AI rules
Removed mechanics	Dice in combat; strict enemy/player tile distinction removed. ³⁶	Not accessible in this session	Compare: earlier drafts in ZIPs/logs

Relationship matrix for known canonical roles

Because named individuals are largely absent from accessible public lore, this matrix is intentionally structural rather than character-by-character.

From \ To	Seekers	Entities	Guardians	Truth	Embodied complications
Seekers	—	Encounter / negotiate / oppose depending on scenario ³⁵	Must be accepted to open Gates ³⁵	Seek/learn/ encounter ³⁵	Opposed by; appear as hindrances ³⁷

From \ To	Seekers	Entities	Guardians	Truth	Embodied complications
Entities	Interact with travelers ³⁵	—	Not stated	Not stated	Potential overlap with enemies (not provable from public text) ³⁶
Guardians	Gatekeepers ³⁵	Not stated	—	Associated with the Gates/ threshold ³⁵	Not stated
Truth	Object of quest ³⁵	Not stated	Not stated	—	Not stated
Embodied complications	Hindrances during Rites/ quest ³⁷	Not stated	Not stated	Not stated	—

Research gaps and verification roadmap

What is missing for “every character / every detail”

The public layer demonstrates that large structured corpora exist, but they are not available for extraction here:

- Versioned rulebooks (DOCX) and card/tables ZIPs are referenced repeatedly (v0.2 PDF, v0.4.1 docx, v0.42 docx + v0.42 cards/tables zip), and the most detail-rich worldbuilding—character sheets, lore pages, scenarios—appears to live inside those files. ³⁸
- As of 2023, the creator indicates that “all game materials” were distributed via direct contact/Discord, meaning the itch page may intentionally function more as devlog + support surface than as a complete canonical repository. ³⁹
- Your Operation Mindfuck ZIPs and prior project conversation logs were not accessible in this session, preventing the requested discrepancy analysis. ⁷

Concrete verification / integration steps once your ZIPs + logs are available

A rigorous “canonical vs Operation Mindfuck” world guide can be fully automated and provenance-annotated if you provide: (a) the Operation Mindfuck ZIP archives and (b) exported conversation logs. The pipeline below is designed to preserve traceability while remaining searchable:

1. **Corpus ingestion & hashing:** unpack ZIPs; compute hashes per file to preserve provenance; record timestamps and version labels if present.
2. **Schema extraction:** parse card manifests and rulebook text to build normalized tables: Characters, Locations, Artifacts/Cards, Factions, Mechanics, Scenarios, Glossary Terms.

3. **Canonical alignment:** treat published itch/devlog statements as “canonical anchors,” then map extracted entities to anchors (e.g., island names, gate mechanics, Presence/Aura/Unspeakable lexicon).
4. **Variant detection:** diff Operation Mindfuck artifacts against canonical anchors, tagging each discrepancy as (a) additive expansion, (b) rename/retcon, (c) rule drift, or (d) contradiction.
5. **Report generation:** regenerate this document with:
 6. full character list (including aliases, physical descriptors if present, relationships)
 7. per-character timelines (derived from scenario references + narrative text)
 8. location atlas and maps (derived from island layouts and scenario maps if present)
 9. artifact index with properties (per card metadata, if present)
 10. cross-reference index (bidirectional links: term → appearances → sources)

The official sources already suggest the material is well-suited to this approach (explicit card categories and counts, card codes, page references for lore and scenarios). 40

1 2 3 5 7 10 12 16 17 18 19 24 32 35 37 [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth?utm_source=chatgpt.com

4 21 34 0.42 update: Storytelling elements, card design and Lore - [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth/devlog/416500/042-update-storytelling-elements-card-design-and-lore?utm_source=chatgpt.com

6 30 Rule updated, playtests and twitch - [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth/devlog/380561/rule-updated-playtests-and-twitch?utm_source=chatgpt.com

8 9 11 13 27 36 39 40 2023, how to play and updates ! - [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth/devlog/549018/2023-how-to-play-and-updates?utm_source=chatgpt.com

14 26 33 38 Version 0.2 out ! And game design breakdown 3 - Ludo-narrative harmony - [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth/devlog/276258/version-02-out-and-game-design-breakdown-3-ludo-narrative-harmony?utm_source=chatgpt.com

15 29 Cards, Discord, Playtests - [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth/devlog/414397/cards-discord-playtests?utm_source=chatgpt.com

20 22 ITCHFUNDING & working with an illustrator - [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth/devlog/285978/itchfunding-working-with-an-illustrator?utm_source=chatgpt.com

23 25 28 GD Breakdown #4: Game genres: expectations vs reality - [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
<https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth/devlog/410765/gd-breakdown-4-game-genres-expectations-vs-reality>

31 Feedback and playtest - [0.2] To the Gates of Truth by The Gates of Truth
https://the-gates-of-truth.itch.io/to-the-gates-of-truth/devlog/263132/feedback-and-playtest?utm_source=chatgpt.com